where she studied gorillas. Her best-selling 1983 book about her experiences—*Gorillas in the Mist*—was later adapted for the screen. Fossey was murdered at her camp in December 1985, probably because of her anti-poaching stance.

See also: Animal behavior

TOMOKO OHTA

1933–

Ohta is a Japanese population geneticist who in 1973 proposed the revolutionary Nearly Neutral Theory, which included the idea that mutations that are neither neutral nor harmful play an important part in evolution. After graduating from the University of Tokyo in 1956, Ohta worked on the cytogenetics (how chromosomes relate to cell behavior) of wheat and sugar beet, and now works at Japan's National Institute of Genetics.

See also: The selfish gene

STANLEY C. WECKER

1933–2010

An American animal behaviorist, Wecker was an influential researcher into animal population and community ecology, especially the study of what determines where animals choose to live. His 1963 paper on habitat selection by prairie deer mice demonstrated that instinct and experience both play a role in how the mice select their habitat.

See also: Ecological niches